TOWN OF APEX
HUMAN RESOURCES DEPARTMENT

REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS
FOR
PUBLIC SAFETY CLASSIFICATION
AND COMPENSATION PLAN

ISSUED
OCTOBER 5, 2026
DUE
NO LATER THAN CLOSE OF BUSINESS ON
OCTOBER 30, 2026

Karmen McGee, Director of Human Resources
Subject line: Public Safety Classification and Compensation Plan RFP

THE TOWN OF APEX RESERVES THE RIGHT TO REJECT ANY OR ALL PROPOSALS RECEIVED, OR TO SELECT THE PROPOSAL WHICH, IN OUR OPINION, IS IN THE BEST OVERALL INTEREST OF THE TOWN. TOWN OF APEX ALSO RESERVES THE RIGHT TO WAIVE INFORMALITIES AND TECHNICALITIES IN THE PROPOSALS. THIS REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS IS NOT AN OFFER, OBLIGATION, OR AGREEMENT TO AWARD WORK TO ANY PROPOSER, AND NO CONTRACTUAL RELATIONSHIP IS CREATED BY RESPONDING TO THIS REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS.

Purpose

The purpose of this Request for Proposals ("RFP") is to solicit proposals from qualified compensation and classification consultant firms (hereinafter referred to as "Consultant") to evaluate and recommend updates to the classification and compensation structures applicable to the Town's Police and Fire positions. This would include reviewing the town's existing classification methodology, job descriptions, compensation structures, market position, pay practices, promotional differentials, specialty pay practices, and implementation procedures. The selected Consultant will provide recommendations that support recruitment, retention, internal equity, and effective administration of Police and Fire Compensation .

Town Background

The Town of Apex is a rapidly growing and developing area located just west of Raleigh, the capital of North Carolina. The Town was incorporated in 1873 and has an estimated population of approximately 86,000 residents. The Town has approximately 740 FTE positions.

The Town maintains separate compensation structures for Police and Fire positions. These structures were implemented in September of 2022. The current study will include sworn police (121 FTEs) and fire (112 FTEs) classifications, as well as designated communications or 911 positions within the project scope. The Town's current compensation philosophy is to lead the applicable market by 5%, on average.

Proposal Instructions

A. **Proposal Deadline**: Must be received by the Town of Apex no later than **October 30, 2026,** at **5:00 PM EST.**

B. **Submission of Proposals:** Vendors must submit both **an electronic PDF** version of the proposal (excluding any materials that are non-electronic) and **three hard copies** with all attachments, including signatory pages, which should be received by the deadline above. The hard copies must be sent to the following delivery address:

   Town of Apex
   Attn: Karmen McGee, Human Resources
   P.O. Box 250
   Apex, NC 27502

   The **electronic PDF version** of the proposal (excluding non-electronic materials) must be submitted by the deadline above to karmen.mcgee@apexnc.org or may be included in the bid packet on digital media.

C. **Withdrawal of Proposals**: Proposing vendors may withdraw their proposals any time before the deadline for submission on **October 30, 2026**, but the withdrawal must be

submitted in writing and signed by the proposing vendor.

D. **Inquiries:** All inquiries relating to this request should be in writing and addressed to:

Town of Apex
Attn: Karmen McGee, Human Resources
P.O. Box 250
Apex, NC 27502

They also may be emailed to: karmen.mcgee@apexnc.org.

E. **Vendor Certification:** The submission of proposal shall be deemed a representation and certification that the proposing vendor:

- Has carefully read and fully understands the information provided by Town of Apex in this RFP;
- Is financially solvent and has the capability to successfully undertake and complete the responsibilities and obligations of the proposal submitted;
- Represents that all of the information contained in the submitted proposal is true and correct;
- Did not in any way collude or conspire with any other parties, directly or indirectly, in regard to the amount, terms, or conditions of this proposal;
- Acknowledges that Town of Apex has the right to make any inquiry it deems appropriate to substantiate or supplement information provided by proposing vendors and hereby grants Town of Apex permission to make these inquiries; and
- Acknowledges that any proposal cannot be modified after its submission for any reason.

F. **Format and Deadline of Proposals:** Late proposals will not be accepted under any circumstance and will not be opened or reviewed. We will not accept proposals by fax or any method other than is outlined under item B of Proposal Instructions. The sender must allow ample delivery time for the selected shipment or transmission methods.

RFP Schedule

Date	Event
October 5, 2026	Distribution of RFP
October 30, 2026	RFP Submission Deadline
November 1 – November 13, 2026	Evaluation Period
November 16 – November 20, 2026	Interviews and Presentations

By November 23, 2026	Selection & Recommendation
November 24 – December 8, 2026	Contract Negotiation & Council Approval
By January 1, 2027	Contract Commences

Contract Period

The term of the Contract shall be for a nine-month period beginning upon the date of execution of the Contract and nine months from the effective date provided that:

- Funds are authorized for this period by the Town of Apex Council,
- Neither the Town nor the Consultant desire to alter the terms of the Contract during the nine-month period, and
- The Contract is not otherwise terminated through provisions of another clause of the Contract.

Fees

Please provide fees, if able, for the duration of the contract period. Fees should be itemized, rather than a final total cost projection. Pricing must be inclusive of all expenses, including travel-related expenses. All costs not explicitly stated in the price quotations shown in the proposal will be excluded from payment consideration by Town in the event that a contract is awarded based on the proposal. Please clearly outline your compensation associated with the required services on a separate compensation addendum.

Scope of Work

The Town of Apex seeks proposals from qualified compensation and classification consultants specializing in local government compensation systems, specifically pay classification and structures for police and fire departments. The selected Consultant must be independent and free from ownership or control by any vendor, company or entity that may create a conflict of interest.

The proposing Consultant must demonstrate a minimum of seven (7) years of experience in creating job classification structures, pay grade structures, and implementation plans to move existing employees and future employees into the new structures.

The selected Consultant shall complete the following deliverables:

- Evaluate all covered Police and Fire positions and designated Communications/911 positions.
- Provide a detailed approach for developing a comprehensive understanding of all covered Police, Fire, and Communications/911 positions.

- Review the duties, responsibilities, qualifications, working conditions, reporting relationships, and organizational structure of each covered position.
- Review and evaluate all existing job descriptions for the covered positions.
- Draft new job descriptions or revise existing job descriptions as needed.
- Review the history and development of the current compensation structures for the covered positions.
- Conduct an internal equity and comparative analysis of the covered positions to determine their relative value within the organization.
- Assess the competitiveness and internal equity of current pay ranges and progression opportunities.
- Review salary compression, promotional relationships, recruitment challenges, and retention risks.
- Evaluate hiring and promotional salary practices, including credit for prior experience; make recommendations for calculation of appropriate starting salaries.
- Recommend classification changes and market-based pay ranges, as appropriate.
- Recommend the appropriate number and structure of pay grades or bands to reflect differences among the covered classifications.
- Define recommended minimum, midpoint, and maximum rates; range spreads; midpoint progression between grades; and the relationship of the pay structure to the relevant labor market.
- Review existing Town compensation policies and recommend revisions or new policies needed to support the recommended structures.
- Develop a classification methodology, such as a point-factor system, for evaluating and reclassifying covered positions.
- Develop employee placement models for any recommended revised pay structures.
- Evaluate and provide recommendations on what specialized positions/assignments should be recognized for incentive pay; recommend appropriate policy revisions and compensation for each.
- Provide an editable spreadsheet, database, or other tool that the Town may own, customize, and use for future classification and reclassification decisions.
- Provide an editable spreadsheet or database to place current employees into the recommended structures while maintaining internal equity.
- Estimate implementation costs and provide transition or phase-in options.
- Ensure any new sworn police and fire pay structures are in compliance with existing Town pay policies or recommend detailed changes to policies or create new policies to supplement the structures if not.
- Provide a new classification system (such as a point-factor methodology) for sworn police and fire positions, including an ongoing spreadsheet or database that the Town may own and customize and use to classify or reclassify sworn police and fire positions going forward.
- Provide a detailed plan, spreadsheet or database to move existing employees into the new structures while protecting sound internal equity.
- Prepare communication materials, including sample emails, presentations, frequently asked questions, and talking points for employees, supervisors, department leaders, and Town

leadership.
- Provide guidance and support for questions, concerns from employees, difficulties utilizing the classification system, etc. for three (3) months after implementation of the newly created or revised sworn police and fire position pay structures.
- Provide all final reports, job descriptions, methodologies, databases, spreadsheets, communication materials, and other deliverables in editable electronic formats.

These deliverables shall be provided no later than March 15, 2027.

Covered Positions:

Police:
- Deputy Police Chief
- Police Captain
- Police Lieutenant
- Police Corporal
- Police Officers (I, II, III, Senior)
- Communications Manager
- Communications Shift Supervisor
- Telecommunicator (I, II, Senior)
- Civilian Traffic Crash Investigator

Fire:
- Assistant Fire Chief
- Fire Battalion Chief
- Fire Captain (I, II)
- Fire Engineer (I, II)
- Firefighter (Cadet, FF, Senior FF)
- Fire Marshall
- Deputy Fire Marshall (I, II)
- Fire Inspector (I, II, III)
- Community Risk Reduction Coordinator
- Fire Training Coordinator (Captain)

Proposal Requirements

Proposals should clearly demonstrate the Consultant's qualifications, experience, resources, and ability to provide the services described in the Scope of Work. Responses should be concise but sufficiently detailed to allow the Town to evaluate the Consultant's capabilities. Please address the following items in the order presented.

Firm Information and Qualifications

1. Provide a brief overview of your firm, including organizational structure, ownership, company

history, and philosophy of service.
2. State the number of years your firm has provided classification and compensation services in general, and the years providing such services to North Carolina municipalities specifically.
3. Identify the regional office that will service the Town's account, including location, primary contact, and staffing resources.

Experience and References

6. Describe your experience serving public sector employers and local governments. Be sure to elaborate on work experience that is specific to public safety organizations.
7. Provide the number of public sector clients currently served and the number of clients with more than 500 full-time employees.
8. Provide a minimum of three (3) references (business name; location; number of benefits-eligible employees; contact name, phone number, and email address) from clients similar in size and complexity to the Town of Apex, including at least:
    - One current municipal or county government client of similar size;
    - One current public sector client is significantly larger than Apex; and
    - One former client.
9. Provide examples of your three largest public sector clients, including years of service, employee population, scope of services provided, and contact information.

Service Team and Account Management

10. Identify the proposed service team, including the account executive, account manager, compliance resources, analytics resources, and any specialists who would support the Town.
11. Describe your service model, including expected response times, escalation procedures, issue resolution processes, and preferred methods of client communication.
12. Describe how your firm stays current on legislative, regulatory, and market developments.

Response to Scope of Services

13. Provide a detailed response to each point on the project scope of services and how you would address and complete that facet of the project. Include estimated timelines, stakeholders, resources needed from the Town, etc.

Communications and Employee Engagement

17. Describe your employee communication and engagement services, including compensation plan implementation support and follow-up.
18. Provide samples of job descriptions, classification structures, pay grade structures, point factor job evaluation systems, etc. that you have created and implemented for a municipal government client.
19. Describe any technology solutions available to support the created classification and pay structures, ongoing classification, etc.

Compensation Disclosure

21. Provide a complete disclosure of all compensation your firm receives or may receive in

connection with the Town's account, including commissions, consulting fees, overrides, contingencies, bonuses, incentives, finder fees, or other forms of direct or indirect compensation.

22. Describe your preferred compensation model and provide a proposed fee schedule for services.

Value-Added Services

23. Describe any additional services, resources, technology, analytics, benchmarking, compliance support, or innovations that distinguish your firm from competitors and would provide value to the Town.

Review and Selection Process

The following criteria will be the basis on which firms will be selected for further consideration:

1. Quality & Completeness of Proposal
2. Specialized Expertise
3. Firm Qualifications, Resources & Capacity
4. Public Sector & Comparable Experience
5. Communications & Employee Engagement
6. Compensation & Pricing
7. Value-Added Services & Innovation

The above listing does not indicate the order of importance. The selection committee shall establish a priority ranking for the final list of criteria for the project.

Proposals Subject to Public Records Laws

All proposals, data, materials, and documentation originated, prepared, and submitted to Town of Apex pursuant to this RFP shall belong exclusively to the Town and may become available to the public in accordance with the North Carolina Public Records Act as provided in N.C.G.S. §132-1 et. seq. The Town of Apex will make reasonable attempts to maintain, in accordance with the Public Records Laws and the Act, the confidentiality of any trade secrets or confidential information that meets the requirements of N.C.G.S. §132-1.2 of the Public Records Laws if such Consultants properly and conspicuously identify the particular data or other materials which are confidential information in accordance with the Public Records Laws.

Negotiation and Execution of Contract

A successful Consultant under this RFP shall negotiate and execute a contract containing such terms and conditions as shall be satisfactory to the Town. The occurrence of negotiations with any Consultant conveys no right or status on such Consultant. By submitting a proposal, each Consultant acknowledges and agrees that the Town may negotiate with one or more Consultant, under such circumstances, at such times and in such a manner as it determines to be in the best interest of the Town of Apex. The

Town reserves the right to enter into a contract with another proposing Consultant in the event that the originally selected Consultant fails to execute a contract with the Town or defaults on their contract.

Governing Law

This RFP and any contract resulting from this RFP shall be governed by and constructed in accordance with the laws of the State of North Carolina. Any and all claims or disputes arising under or in connection with this RFP or the contract shall be exclusively governed by the laws of the State of North Carolina, and venue shall be exclusively within Wake County, North Carolina.

Town Requirements

Insurance Requirements

During the term of the contract, the Contractor at its sole cost and expense shall provide commercial insurance of such type and with such terms and limits as may be reasonably associated with the contract. As a minimum, the Contractor shall provide and maintain the following coverage and limits:

(a) **Worker's Compensation** - The contractor shall provide and maintain Worker's Compensation Insurance as required by the laws of North Carolina, as well as employer's liability coverage with minimum limits of $500,000.00, covering all of Contractor's employees who are engaged in any work under the contract. If any work is sublet, the Contractor shall require the subcontractor to provide the same coverage for any of his employees engaged in any work under the contract. (Non-applicable individual.)

(b) **Commercial General Liability** - General Liability Coverage on a Comprehensive Broad Form in the minimum amount of $2,000,000 aggregate, $1,000,000 per occurrence. (Defense cost shall be in excess of the limit of liability.)

(c) **Automobile** - Automobile Liability Insurance, to include liability coverage, covering all owned, hired, and non-owned vehicles used in performance of the contract. The minimum combined single limit shall be $250,000.00 bodily injury and $100,000 property damage.

(d) **Cyber Liability** – Cyber liability coverage in the minimum amount of $1,000,000 per incident/$1,000,000 annual aggregate.

Providing and maintaining adequate insurance coverage is a material obligation of the Contractor and is of the essence of this contract. The Contractor may meet its requirements of maintaining specified coverage and limits by demonstrating to the Town that there is in force insurance with equivalent coverage and limits that will offer at least the same protection to the Town. All such insurance shall meet all laws of the State of North Carolina. Such insurance coverage shall be obtained from companies that are authorized to provide such coverage and that are authorized by the Commissioner of Insurance to do business in North Carolina. The Contractor shall at all times comply with the terms of such insurance policies, and all requirements of the insurer under any

such insurance policies, except as they may conflict with existing North Carolina laws or this contract. The limits of coverage under each insurance policy maintained by the Contractor shall not be interpreted as limiting the contractor's.

E-Verify

Effective September 4, 2013, North Carolina local government units are prohibited from entering into certain contracts unless the contractor and the contractor's subcontractors, if any, comply with the requirements of N.C. Gen. Stats. §64-26(a). Prior to providing any services hereunder, Contractor and Contractor's subcontractors, if any, are subject to the provisions of N.C. Gen. Stats. §64-26(a).

Contractor agrees to fully comply with such statute and require Contractor's subcontractors, if any, to fully comply with such statute.

Iran Divestment Act

Effective October 1, 2015, North Carolina local government units are prohibited from entering into certain contracts unless the contractor and the contractor's subcontractors, if any, comply with the requirements of §143C-6A-5. Contractor agrees to fully comply with such statute and require Contractor's subcontractors, if any, to fully comply with such statute.

Additional Town Conditions

- All proposing firms or individuals shall comply with all conditions, requirements, and specifications contained herein, with any departure constituting sufficient cause for rejection of the proposals. However, Town of Apex reserves the right to change the conditions, requirements, and specifications as it deems necessary.
- The proposal must be signed by a duly authorized official of the proposing organization or individual submitting the proposal.
- No proposal will be accepted from any person or organization that is in arrears for any obligation to Town of Apex, or that otherwise may be deemed irresponsible or unresponsive by Town staff or the Town of Apex Council.
- Town of Apex is not obligated to enter into any contract as a result of the RFP.
- Town of Apex reserves the right to reject any and all proposals or any part thereof and to select the most responsive, responsible proposal that is deemed in the best interest of Town of Apex.
- Only one proposal will be awarded as the result of the RFP.
- Town of Apex may approve or disapprove the use of specific proposed subcontractors in any proposal.
- Town of Apex reserves the right to enter into an agreement with another proposing vendor in the event that the originally selected vendor fails to execute a contract with the Town or defaults on their contract.
- All proposals shall be prepared in a comprehensive manner as to content, but we do

not require specific types of binders or promotional material for submissions. Promotional material will not be considered part of the proposal and will not affect the evaluation of proposals.

- Town of Apex reserves the right to negotiate with any, none, or all of the proposing vendors.
- All costs, including travel and expenses, incurred in the preparation of this proposal will be borne solely by the proposing company.
- The Town will not return proposal materials to those submitting proposals.
- No agreements with any selected vendor shall be binding until a contract is approved, signed, and executed by the authorized Town Official and authorized representatives of the vendor.

It is the policy of the Town of Apex to ensure that no person shall, on the grounds of race, color, national origin, limited English language proficiency, income level, sex, pregnancy, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, age, National Guard or veteran status, or disability, be excluded from participation in, be denied the benefits of, or be otherwise subjected to discrimination under any Town of Apex program or activity, including, where applicable, religion, as provided by Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and other pertinent nondiscrimination authorities.

EXECUTION OF PROPOSAL

DATE: _____

The Consultant certifies the following by checking the following boxes:

☐ That this proposal was signed by an authorized representative of the Consultant's firm.

☐ That the Consultant has determined the cost and availability of all materials and supplies associated with performing the services outlined herein.

☐ That all labor costs associated with this project have been determined, including all direct and indirect costs.

☐ That the Consultant agrees to the conditions as set forth in this **Request for Proposals** with no exceptions.

Therefore, in compliance with the foregoing **Request for Proposals**, and subject to all terms and conditions thereof, the undersigned offers and agrees, if this proposal is accepted within thirty (30) days from the date of the opening, to furnish the services for the prices quoted within the timeframe required.

CONSULTANT_____

ADDRESS _____

CITY, STATE, & ZIP CODE _____

PHONE_____ FAX _____

BY _____ TITLE _____
Signature

_____ _____
Type or Printed Name Federal Identification Number

THIS PAGE MUST BE COMPLETED AND SUBMITTED AS A PART OF YOUR PROPOSAL.

STATE OF NORTH CAROLINA
TOWN OF APEX
AFFIDAVIT OF COMPLIANCE with N.C. E-Verify Statutes
(See Reverse side for NC G.S. 143-133.3 which includes contract exceptions)

I, _____ (hereinafter the "Affiant"), duly authorized by and on behalf of _____ (hereinafter the "Employer") after being first duly sworn deposes and says as follows:

1. I am the _____ (President, Manager, CEO, etc.) of the Employer and possess the full authority to speak for and on behalf of the Employer identified above.

2. Employer understands that "E-Verify" means the federal E-Verify program operated by the United States Dept. of Homeland Security and other federal agencies, or any successor or equivalent program used to verify the work authorization of newly hired employees pursuant to federal law in accordance with NCGS §143-133.3 (c)(2).

3. Employer is a person, business entity, or other organization that transacts business in this State and that employs 25 or more employees in the State. (mark Yes or No)

a. YES _____, or
b. NO _____

4. Employer has complied with and will maintain compliance with all applicable federal and North Carolina E-Verify statutes, rules & regulations.

5. All subcontractors engaged by or to be engaged by Employer have or will have likewise complied with all federal and North Carolina E-Verify statutes, rules & regulations.

6. Employers shall keep the Town of Apex informed of any change in its status pursuant to Article 2 of Chapter 64 of the North Carolina General Statutes.

This the _____ day of _____, 20_____.

STATE OF _____, COUNTY OF _____

Sworn to and subscribed before me, this the _____ day of 20_____.

_____
Notary Public

Affix Official/Notarial Seal Here

SEAL

_____
Signature of Affiant

My commission expires: _____

§ 143-133.3 E-Verify compliance.

(a) No board or governing body of the State, or of any institution of the State government, or of any political subdivision of the State, may enter into a contract unless the contractor, and the contractor's subcontractors under the contract, comply with the requirements of Article 2 of Chapter 64 of the General Statutes.
(b) A board or governing body of the State, or of any institution of the State government, or of any political subdivision of the State, shall be deemed in compliance with this section if the contract includes a term requiring the contractor, and the contractor's subcontractors, to comply with the requirements of Article 2 of Chapter 64 of the General Statutes.
(c) This section shall not apply to any of the following:

(1) Expenses related to travel, including transportation and lodging, for employees, officers, agents, or
members of State or local boards, commissions, committees, or councils.
(2) Contracts solely for the purchase of goods, apparatus, supplies, materials, or equipment.
(3) Contracts let under G.S. 143-129(e)(1), (9), or (9a).
(4) Contracts let under G.S. 143-129(g). (2015-294, s. 1(a).)